



Photography by AP

**MAHINDA RAJAPAKSA WAVES TO HIS SUPPORTERS AFTER WINNING RE-ELECTION WHILE HIS RIVAL SARATH FONSEKA (BELOW) CALLED FOR THE RESULTS TO BE NULLIFIED**

Rajapaksa also trotted out a variety of politicians to personally discredit Fonseka. They alleged primarily that Fonseka had taken kickbacks for weapons deals through a company he owned and operated. Ultimately, however, indebtedness towards Rajapaksa outdid anything Fonseka and his large alliance of backers had to offer. The incumbent President's re-election bid was further assisted by the fact that voters were uncertain of the future after a Fonseka win. How, for instance, would the Marxist Janatha Vimukthi Peramuna (JVP) work with the centre-right UNP? Was Fonseka a front for the unpopular Ranil Wickremesinghe? Did Fonseka really have a "secret pact" with the Tamil National Alliance who were once proxies of the LTTE? Some of these doubts were never really cleared.

Having succeeded in his gambit of an early presidential election,

